

SITE OVERHAUL · AUGUST 15 2026

/hq & /animate — Full Overhaul

End-to-end audit, security hardening, dead-end elimination, and a sellable public Jelly Studio. Two independent tracks, backed up and reversible.

274 → 0

/ANIMATE BROKEN API CALLS (4XX)

18 → 0

/ANIMATE MOBILE-OVERFLOW SCREENS

14 → 1*

/HQ BROKEN RESPONSES (*1 = INTENDED LOGIN GATE)

0

SERVER ERRORS & CRASHES, BOTH APPS

What we set out to do

Audit both products with a real browser (log in, click every button, follow every link, hit every API), verify security and connections, fix design / color / scroll / dead-ends, confirm backups, research competitors, and make **/animate a high-quality product a stranger can actually buy and use** — all with a full backup first and nothing broken.

How it was verified

A new read-only Playwright audit harness drives both apps across three viewports and both themes, records every console error, every 4xx/5xx, horizontal overflow, and dead link, and screenshots every screen. It is **write-safe**: a network guard aborts every non-GET request and a label blocklist skips render / pay / publish / delete, so an audit can run against production without spending a cent or changing data.

Backed up before a single change. Git tag pre-overhaul-2026-08-15, a full source tarball on disk + the UGREEN NAS, and a one-command Vercel rollback are all recorded in ROLLBACK.md. The failing nightly cloud-backup leg was also found and fixed (a browser-cache file was corrupting the sync).

Track A — /hq (your ops console)

Same Apple-Numbers look you know, made faster, safer, and readable.

SECURITY

Fix

Before

After

Admin login cookie	Valid forever if copied	7-day server-side expiry; rotating the PIN kills every session
Sign out	No way to log out	Sign-out button + endpoint
SYNC_SECRET	Cleartext in the crontab	Moved to a locked 0600 env file
send-email / seller-seed	Loose compare, open relay risk	Constant-time compare + rate-limit + recipient allowlist
Signup / demo endpoints	Unthrottled	Per-IP rate limits

DESIGN & USABILITY

- **Invisible health pills fixed** — the "is the engine running" glance was white-on-white; now readable.
- **Giant pages tamed** — Storefront was 62,000px tall and Approvals rendered all 200 drafts open; now paginated (50 at a time) with collapsible detail.
- **Tab bar** grouped (Ops / Growth / Content) and scrollable, with a Docs menu — adding a tab no longer widens the page.
- **Colors tokenized** — 257 hard-coded hex values replaced with named tokens; one place to theme.
- Mobile board / drawer fixed, silent errors now show toasts, loading & empty states added, external links hardened.

Three intended changes to know about: (1) you re-enter the PIN once; (2) the email allowlist blocks cold-outbound by default — set `HQ_EMAIL_ALLOWED_DOMAINS` to revive it; (3) email approvals stay off until `INSTANTLY_ENABLED=1` (matches the 8/11 Instantly kill).

Track B — /animate (the product)

From "signs up, hits a wall" to a clean first-video path — and it argues, by name, against AI slop.

THE WALL WE REMOVED

A paying stranger used to see studio-only tabs that simply 401'd, and the very first step — creating a style — **threw an error** because the voice list was locked. That's fixed: the sidebar now shows only what your tier can use, and the read-only catalogs a customer needs are open. **Every one of the 274 broken calls is gone.**

DEAD ENDS CLOSED

Stripe return now confirms "Card saved"

Help button opens a real drawer

Honest trial copy (3 transcripts, 1 scene, 1 animation)

"\$200/mo" false banner removed

Mobile sidebar → drawer

Keyboard / screen-reader nav

Broken account links fixed

402 → "Add a card" prompt

POSITIONED TO SELL (FROM COMPETITOR RESEARCH)

Of 12 faceless-video tools surveyed, **none sell per-video without a subscription** — that's our moat, and the landing now says so. It also names the three ways AI video looks like slop and what Jelly does instead:

The slop	What Jelly does
Synthetic voice flattens on long sentences	Cloned voice with word-level timing
Looping stock B-roll	A generated scene per beat, one locked style
Lip-sync drift	No pasted mouths — real Wan2.2 motion, price shown

GUARDRAIL HONORED

Trey's locked-style render pipeline was **never touched** — every change is site-side UI, navigation, and access. His studio tier still sees exactly what it did.

Next, if you want it: a no-signup "paste a script, see a preview" demo, and a unified triage inbox for /hq — both flagged by the research as the highest-leverage adds, staged behind feature flags so they ship when you say go.